

# Hosting Manual

Deploying to cPanel · [www.hausaly.com/nusuk](https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk)

How the platform was deployed to **<https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/>** on **Truehost cPanel (Web Hosting Starter)** using *Setup Node.js App*. Follow this to deploy it again, move it, or recover it.

## 1. What you are deploying

| Item         | Detail                                                                       |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| App          | Node.js web app (site + request forms + admin dashboard)                     |
| Dependencies | <b>None</b> (no <code>npm install</code> needed)                             |
| Node version | <b>22.13 or newer</b> (uses built-in SQLite). Truehost offers 22.23.3        |
| Database     | One SQLite file: <code>nusuk.db</code> (kept <b>outside</b> the code folder) |
| Entry file   | <code>app.cjs</code>                                                         |
| URL path     | <code>/nusuk</code> (set with <code>BASE_PATH</code> )                       |

### Before you start, confirm:

- ☐ cPanel has **Setup Node.js App** (search "node" in cPanel's tool search)
- ☐ The version list includes **22.13+**
- ☐ The domain's DNS already points to the hosting (A record = the server IP)
- ☐ You have the project ZIP from GitHub

If either of the first two is missing, the app cannot run on that plan — ask the host to enable Node 22, or use a VPS (Appendix A).

## 2. Folder layout (cPanel home = `/home/<cpanel-user>`)

```
/home/<cpanel-user>/
├─ nusuk/                ← APPLICATION ROOT (code lives here)
│   ├── app.cjs           ← startup file
│   ├── package.json
│   ├── server/           ← index.js, db.js, auth.js, validate.js, config.js
│   ├── public/           ← index.html, css/, js/, img/
│   └─ test/
├─ nusuk-data/           ← DATABASE (created automatically; never delete)
└─ public_html/          ← your main website (not touched)
```

**Golden rule:** the files `app.cjs`, `server/`, `public/` must sit **directly** inside `nusuk/`, not in a sub-folder.

## 3. First-time deployment

### Step 1 — Download the project

1. Open the GitHub repository → choose the branch → **Code** → **Download ZIP**.
2. You get `Nusuk-<branch>.zip`.

### Step 2 — Upload the code

1. cPanel → **File Manager**.
2. Go to `/home/<cpanel-user>` and create a folder named `nusuk`.
3. Open `nusuk` → **Upload** → select the ZIP.
4. Right-click the ZIP → **Extract** (into `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk`).
5. Open the new folder (`Nusuk-<branch>`), **Select All** → **Move** to `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk`. (Turn on **Settings** → **Show Hidden Files** first.)
6. Delete the empty extracted folder and the ZIP.
7. Check the layout matches section 2.

### Step 3 — Create the Node.js app

cPanel → **Setup Node.js App** → **Create Application**:

| Field                    | Value                                                       |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Node.js version          | <b>22.x</b> (e.g. 22.23.3)                                  |
| Application mode         | Production                                                  |
| Application root         | nusuk                                                       |
| Application URL          | pick your domain, and type nusuk in the path box next to it |
| Application startup file | app.cjs                                                     |

⚠ Do not leave the path box empty — the site will return 404.

**Environment variables** (Add variable for each):

| Name           | Value                          | Meaning                                  |
|----------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| BASE_PATH      | /nusuk                         | Serve under /nusuk                       |
| HTTPS          | 1                              | Secure cookies (site must use https)     |
| ADMIN_EMAIL    | your email                     | First administrator login                |
| ADMIN_PASSWORD | a strong password (10+ chars)  | First administrator password             |
| DATA_DIR       | /home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk-data | Database location (outside public_html ) |

Click **Create**, then **Start/Restart**.

ADMIN\_EMAIL / ADMIN\_PASSWORD are only read the **first time** the app starts. Change the password later in **Dashboard → Users**, not here.

#### Step 4 — Fix the .htaccess (required on Truehost)

Truehost adds a WordPress rewrite block that sends every non-file URL to a missing `index.php`. That blocks the app's API ( `/nusuk/api/...` ) and gives a 404.

1. File Manager → **Settings** → **Show Hidden Files**.
2. Find the `.htaccess` that contains lines starting `PassengerAppRoot` (cPanel created it when you made the app — in `public_html` or `public_html/nusuk` ).
3. **Copy** it first as a backup ( `.htaccess.bak` ).
4. Edit it and **delete only** the block shown below.

```
# BEGIN WordPress
RewriteEngine On
RewriteBase /
RewriteRule ^index\.php$ - [L]
RewriteCond %{REQUEST_FILENAME} !-f
RewriteCond %{REQUEST_FILENAME} !-d
RewriteRule . /index.php [L]
# END WordPress
```

Keep the Passenger lines, the HTTPS redirect and the security rules, then continue:

5. Save, then **Restart** the Node app.

## Step 5 — Verify

1. Open `https://www.<domain>/nusuk/api/health` → must show `{"ok":true}`.
2. Open `https://www.<domain>/nusuk/` (keep the trailing slash) → the site loads.
3. Open `/nusuk/#/login` → sign in with `ADMIN_EMAIL` / `ADMIN_PASSWORD`.
4. **Immediately** change the admin password: **Dashboard** → **Users** → **Edit**.
5. Submit a test request on the Interest Form and confirm it appears in **Dashboard** → **Service Requests**.

## 4. First-time setup inside the dashboard

1. **Users** → change your password; add staff accounts if needed ( `staff` cannot see Users/Settings).
2. **Settings** → **Platform FX rate** → enter Naira per 1 Saudi Riyal (shown in the top bar; hidden until set).
3. **Settings** → **Brochures / YouTube** → add the links (buttons stay disabled until filled).
4. Replace the **Privacy Policy** placeholder text before launch ( `public/js/app.js`, `privacy` view).

## 4b. DIY Booking (hotels, HHR train, transfers)

- **Payments are manual by default.** No extra settings are needed: a client reserves a hotel, receives a slip marked *payment pending*, your team contacts them, and you click **Mark as PAID** on the order (Dashboard → DIY Orders).
- **Before clients can book hotels:** set the **Platform FX rate** (Settings) and add hotels (Dashboard → Hotel Inventory — add one by one, or bulk-upload the Excel template). Set your default **mark-up %** in Settings.
- **Uploads on shared hosting:** hotel files are stored next to the database ( `nusuk-data/media` and `nusuk-data/offers` ) — they are included when you back up `nusuk-data`.
- **Turning on Paystack later:** add `PAYSTACK_SECRET_KEY` (start with the `sk_test_...` key) and `PUBLIC_URL=https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk`, set the Paystack webhook to

`https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/api/paystack/webhook`, restart, then use **Settings → Check Paystack connection**. Never share screenshots showing the secret key.

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## 5. Updating the live site (after new changes)

1. **Back up** `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk-data/nusuk.db` (File Manager → Download).
2. Download the new ZIP from GitHub.
3. In `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk` **delete**: folders `public`, `server`, `test`; files `app.cjs`, `package.json`, `README.md`, `Dockerfile`. **Never delete**: `tmp`, and the separate `nusuk-data` folder.
4. Upload the ZIP → Extract → Select All inside the extracted folder → **Move** to `nusuk` → delete the leftovers.
5. **Setup Node.js App → Restart**.
6. Test `/nusuk/api/health`, then hard-refresh the site (**Ctrl+Shift+R**).

*Only changed `public/` files (HTML/CSS/JS/images)?* No restart is needed — upload and hard-refresh. *Changed anything in `server/` or `app.cjs`?* Restart the app.

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## 6. Backups and recovery

- **Back up**: download `nusuk-data/nusuk.db` regularly (weekly, and before every update). It holds all requests, bookings, users, inventory and settings.
  - **Restore**: upload the saved `nusuk.db` back into `nusuk-data/` and restart the app.
  - **Lost admin password**: in File Manager, rename `nusuk-data/nusuk.db` to `nusuk.db.old`, set new `ADMIN_EMAIL` / `ADMIN_PASSWORD` variables, restart (a new empty database and admin are created). Re-import is not automatic — keep the old file for reference.
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## 7. Troubleshooting

| Symptom                                                     | Likely cause                                                                               | Fix                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>hausaly.com/nusuk/</code> → black <b>404</b> page     | Application URL path empty, or code one folder too deep                                    | Set path <code>nusuk</code> and Save; fix layout (section 2)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Page loads but login says <b>"Request failed"</b>           | App not receiving API calls (WordPress rule in <code>.htaccess</code> ) or app not running | Step 4; Restart; check <code>/api/health</code>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <code>/api/health</code> → 404                              | Same as above                                                                              | Step 4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <code>/api/health</code> → 500/503 or "Incomplete response" | App crashed on start                                                                       | Open <code>nusuk/stderr.log</code> and <code>nusuk/boot.log</code> in File Manager                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| No <code>boot.log</code> appears                            | cPanel is not running <code>app.cjs</code>                                                 | Check startup file name, application root, app is Started                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Login works but you are logged out at once                  | <code>HTTPS=1</code> but visiting <code>http://</code>                                     | Use <code>https://</code>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Old design / old page still showing                         | Files not replaced, or a cached copy                                                       | Compare the <b>Build number</b> in the site footer (small text, bottom) with <code>/nusuk/api/health</code> ( <code>"build"</code> ). Same number = files are current → <b>Ctrl+Shift+R</b> . Different or missing = the upload didn't replace the files (re-do the update steps) or the Node app wasn't restarted |
| <code>.htaccess</code> block comes back                     | Truehost regenerated it                                                                    | Repeat Step 4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Node version list tops out below 22                         | Plan limitation                                                                            | Ask the host to enable Node 22, or use a VPS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

**Diagnostic files** (in `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk/`):

- `boot.log` — written by `app.cjs`: startup info, errors, first 30 requests.
- `stderr.log` — written by cPanel: the app's error output. Delete both once everything works.

### Useful checks

- Health: `/nusuk/api/health` → `{"ok":true}`
- cPanel → **Metrics** → **Errors** shows recent Apache errors.

## 8. Security checklist

- ☐ Admin password changed from the one used at first start
- ☐ Never share screenshots showing environment-variable values (they include the password)
- ☐ `DATA_DIR` is **outside** `public_html`

- ☐ Site is served over **https** and `HTTPS=1` is set
- ☐ Staff accounts use the `staff` role, not `admin`
- ☐ Database backed up and stored off the server

## Appendix A — Deploying on a VPS instead (Docker)

```
git clone https://github.com/<owner>/Nusuk && cd Nusuk
docker build -t nusuk-consult .
docker run -d --name nusuk --restart=always -p 127.0.0.1:3000:3000 -v nusuk-data:/data \
  -e BASE_PATH=/nusuk -e HTTPS=1 -e ADMIN_EMAIL=you@example.com -e
  ADMIN_PASSWORD='StrongPassword' nusuk-consult
```

Reverse-proxy `/nusuk` (path unchanged) to `127.0.0.1:3000`:

```
# Caddy
www.example.com { handle /nusuk* { reverse_proxy 127.0.0.1:3000 } }
```

```
# nginx
location /nusuk/ { proxy_pass http://127.0.0.1:3000; proxy_set_header Host $host;
proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-For $remote_addr; }
location = /nusuk { return 301 /nusuk/; }
```

Leave `BASE_PATH` empty to serve at the domain root or on a subdomain.

## Appendix B — Environment variable reference

| Variable                        | Default                       | Purpose                                                |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>PORT</code>               | 3000                          | Listening port (cPanel/Passenger overrides it)         |
| <code>DATA_DIR</code>           | <code>./data</code>           | Folder for <code>nusuk.db</code>                       |
| <code>BASE_PATH</code>          | <i>(empty)</i>                | Sub-path, e.g. <code>/nusuk</code>                     |
| <code>HTTPS</code>              | 0                             | <code>1</code> = secure cookies, trust proxy headers   |
| <code>ADMIN_EMAIL</code>        | admin@nusuk.com.ng            | First admin email (first start only)                   |
| <code>ADMIN_PASSWORD</code>     | <i>(random, printed once)</i> | First admin password (first start only)                |
| <code>NOTIFY_WEBHOOK_URL</code> | <i>(empty)</i>                | Optional JSON notification on each new request/booking |

## Appendix C — Quick reference

```
Site:           https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/
Admin login:    https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/#/login
Health:        https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/api/health
App root:       /home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk      startup file: app.cjs
Database:       /home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk-data/nusuk.db
Restart:       cPanel → Setup Node.js App → Restart
```